

Sahana Vijay

(408) 462-2544 | sahana9vijay@gmail.com | San Jose, CA | [LinkedIn](#) | [Portfolio](#)

Education

University of California Santa Cruz

June 2026

B.S. in Cognitive Science (Specialization in AI & HCI) | Minor in Computer Science | GPA: 3.88

Relevant Coursework: UI/UX Design, Databases, Human-Centered AI, Research Methods in Psychology, Psychological Data Analysis, Visual & Spatial Cognition, Statistics, Python Abstractions.

Skills

- **Product & Strategy:** Market/Competitive Benchmarking, Metric Prioritization & Categorization, KPI/North Star Metric Definition, Roadmapping, Product Requirements, Data Governance, Stakeholder Reporting.
- **Research & Validation:** User Interviews, Usability Testing, Journey Mapping, Mixed-Methods Survey Design, Experimental Design, Statistical Testing (Regression, T-Tests).
- **Tools:** Figma, Amplitude, Looker Studio, SQL, Qualtrics, Excel, SPSS, Python.

Experiences

Phygtl, Inc.

April 2026 - Current

AI Analyst Intern | Remote

- Benchmarked TagAlong (the product) against 8 market comparables, surfacing category gaps that directly informed product metric strategy.
- Prioritized and categorized 10 investor-facing metrics into a Growth/Engagement/Trust & Safety/Virality framework, then shipped it as a live investor dashboard (Looker Studio + Supabase) used by engineering, product, and investors.
- Architected 9 AI monitoring agents in Amplitude with defined escalation thresholds and data-governance/dedup rules, then ran usability testing on the product they monitor — closing the loop with iteration recommendations that shaped what the agents flag. [View here](#)

UCSC Computer Vision Lab

March 2025 - June 2025

Research Assistant | Santa Cruz, CA

- Designed and executed 15 usability testing trials across 8 configurations to optimize an accessibility-focused interface for users with upper-limb impairments.
- Analyzed 120 performance data points (RMSE metrics) in SPSS and Excel to measure usability effectiveness and prioritize fixes.
- Applied human factors principles to refine calibration workflows, producing 13+ visualizations that guided iterative product improvements.

Ohlone College

November 2023 - May 2024

Program Research Intern | Fremont, CA

- Scoped and managed end-to-end qualitative and quantitative research to diagnose completion barriers in a high-profile Tesla-funded technical certification program.
- Recruited, screened, and surveyed 60+ participants across 3 mixed-methods research cycles to pinpoint core operational and accessibility pain points.
- Documented findings in an executive-level presentation and pitched a strategic hybrid delivery model, driving a 50% increase in student enrollment.

Projects

[Slug Housing App](#) | Product Strategist & Researcher

January 2026 - March 2026

- Framed the core product bet (preference-based matching over open-ended browsing) and validated it through user research, translating findings into ranked product requirements.
- Synthesized a journey map across 2 user segments to identify the highest-drop-off stage, using it to justify a split onboarding flow and define a KPI framework anchored on a North Star metric (search-to-lease conversion).
- Directed information architecture and wireframing across a 5-person team, then ran moderated usability testing (4 participants) that drove measurable navigation and onboarding fixes.